SMM
Shanghai Metals Market
SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-23 Friday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

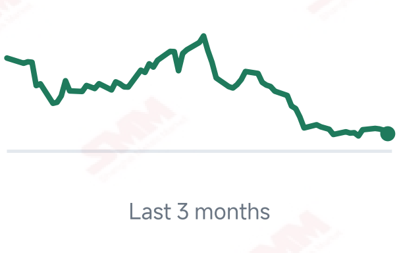
Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price

90.75
USD/dmt
FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX
As of preparation: 2026-10-23 18:14:38 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-23 17:54:19 (UTC+8)


Last 3 months

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

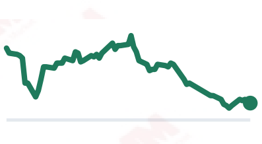
675.0
yuan/mt
▲ +6.0 +0.90%
MTD avg **677.7**
As of Oct 23 · vs Oct 22

Last 3 months

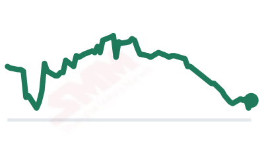
SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 23

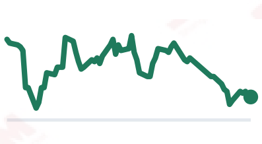
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily
658
yuan/wmt
▲ +2 +0.30%
MTD avg **659**


Last 3 months

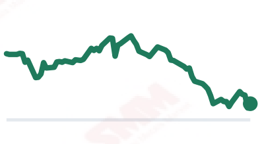
MMi 58% Port Spot Daily
616
yuan/wmt
▲ +5 +0.82%
MTD avg **618**


Last 3 months

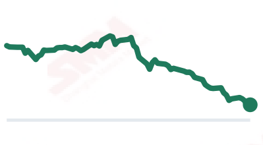
MMi 65% Port Spot Daily
817
yuan/wmt
▲ +2 +0.25%
MTD avg **820**


Last 3 months

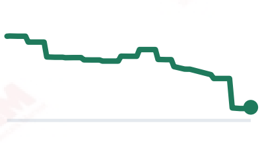
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily
89.20
USD/dmt
▲ +0.60 +0.68%
MTD avg **90.38**


Last 3 months

MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily
106.80
USD/dmt
▲ +0.55 +0.52%
MTD avg **108.84**


Last 3 months

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily
797.36
yuan/mt
▲ +1.03 +0.13%
MTD avg **809.35**
As of Oct 23 · vs Oct 22


Last 3 months

Key View

Futures and spot prices recover together; sustained transactions remain key

Prices recovered together today, easing the previous session's broad weakness. DCE most-traded rose 0.90% to 675.0 yuan/mt; the 61%, 58% and 65% port indices increased to 658, 616 and 817 yuan/wmt. The seaborne 61% and 65% indices were USD 89.20 and 106.80/dmt, with all 12 brands higher. Direction was broadly aligned, but a one-day rebound still needs persistent buying support.

Marginal production improvement supports baseline consumption. Latest surveyed daily hot metal output was 2.3584 million mt, up 6,400 mt, while the latest shipments and arrivals both declined. Nevertheless, raw-material stocks, finished-steel margins and orders determine whether mills restock actively; weaker transport flows do not substitute for evidence of stock absorption.

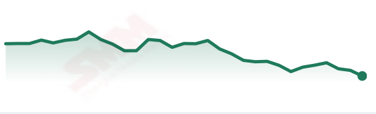
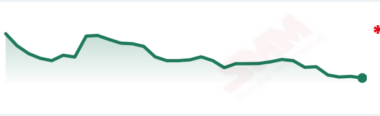
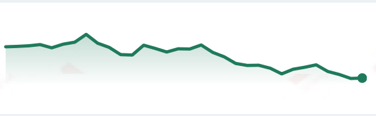
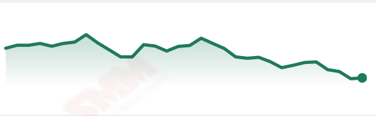
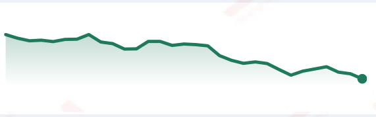
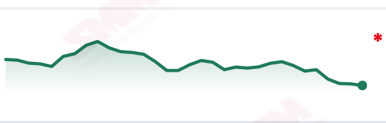
The near-term focus is whether firmer prices and transactions reinforce each other. Persistent buying alongside better profitability could strengthen downside support, while a recovery confined to offers could limit further gains. Higher freight adds a cost variable, making contracts and exchange rates important to actual margins. A range-bound view remains appropriate.

Today's Highlights

- **Futures and spot prices recovered.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **675.0 yuan/mt**, up 6.0 yuan (+0.90%). Qingdao PB and Newman Fines were both 643 yuan/wmt, up 4 yuan; Mac Fines rose 3 yuan to 649, while the other listed products each gained 4 yuan.
- **Seaborne indices and brand quotations recovered together.** The 61% index was **USD 89.20/dmt**, up 0.60 (+0.68%), and the 65% was **106.80**, up 0.55 (+0.52%). All 12 brands increased against the Oct 22 report; PB Fines were 89.55, Newman Fines 88.65 and Mac Fines 88.95 USD/dmt.
- **The low-grade port index rose more strongly.** The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 658, 616 and 817 yuan/wmt, up 2, 5 and 2 yuan. The 65%-58% spread narrowed from 204 to 201 yuan/wmt.
- **The domestic ore composite index edged higher.** The Oct 23 index was 797.36 yuan/mt, up 1.03 yuan (+0.13%) from 796.33 previously. Regional transactions and mill purchasing intensity remain important to the durability of the recovery.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-23 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	643	▲ +4 +0.63%	646	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	643	▲ +4 +0.63%	648	 *
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	649	▲ +3 +0.46%	650	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	696	▲ +4 +0.58%	697	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	833	▲ +4 +0.48%	839	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	505	▲ +4 +0.80%	508	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	818	▲ +4 +0.49%	824	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	823	▲ +4 +0.49%	832	 *

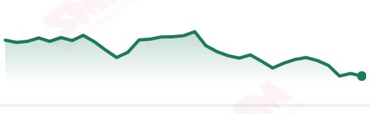
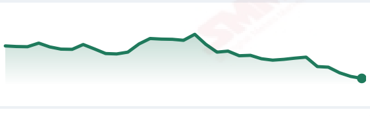
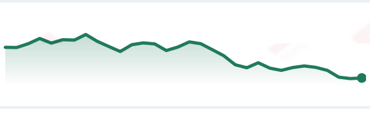
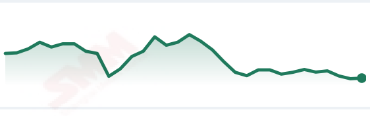
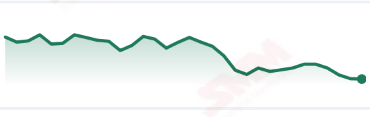
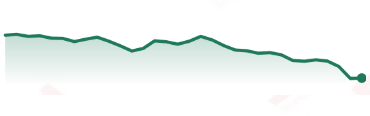
Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-23 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-22
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	86.10	▲ +0.60 +0.70%	85.50
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	87.80	▲ +0.60 +0.69%	87.20
PB Fines 62% Daily	89.55	▲ +0.65 +0.73%	88.90
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	88.65	▲ +0.60 +0.68%	88.05
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	88.95	▲ +0.60 +0.68%	88.35
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	86.45	▲ +0.85 +0.99%	85.60
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	105.50	▲ +0.60 +0.57%	104.90
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	96.50	▲ +0.60 +0.63%	95.90
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	96.05	▲ +0.60 +0.63%	95.45
RTX Fines 61% Daily	85.30	▲ +0.75 +0.89%	84.55
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	89.20	▲ +0.60 +0.68%	88.60
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	79.30	▲ +0.95 +1.21%	78.35

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.38	-6.35%	-15.8%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	108.84	-4.89%	-12.0%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	659	-4.79%	-19.1%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	820	-2.34%	-9.1%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	618	-4.51%	-14.2%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	809.35	-3.48%	-10.1%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 89.20/dmt (+0.68%) and the 65% was 106.80 (+0.52%), narrowing their spread from USD 17.65 to 17.60/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 658, 616 and 817 yuan/wmt, up 2, 5 and 2 yuan.

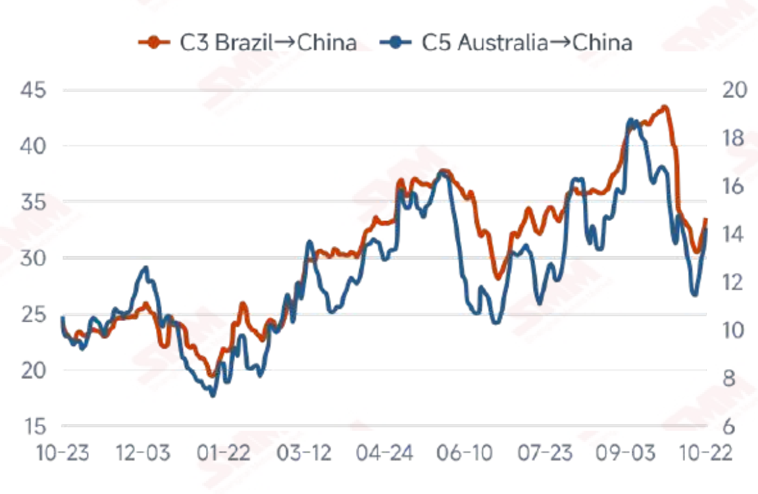
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

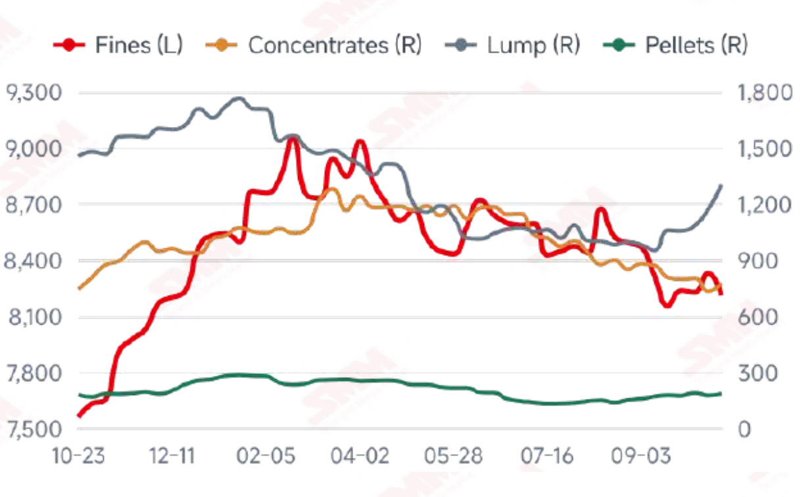
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



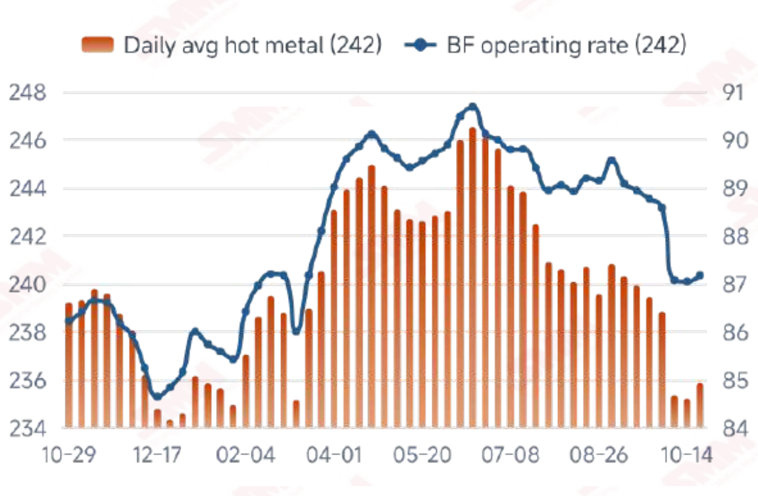
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



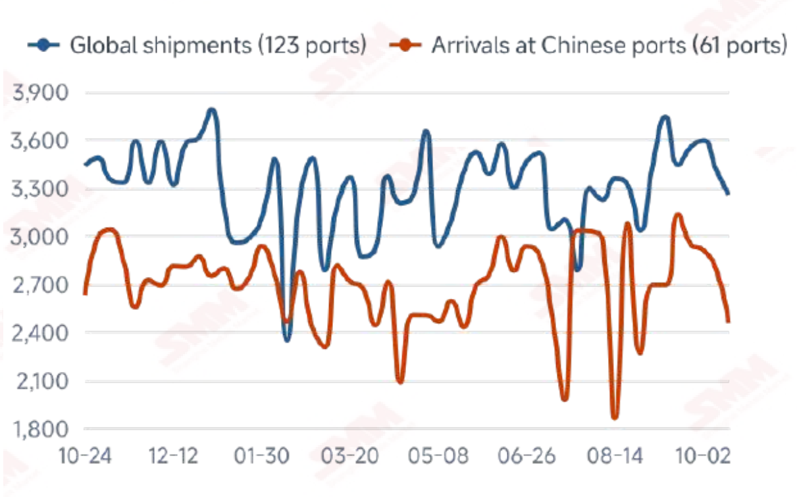
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 675.0 yuan/mt, up 0.90% from the previous session. Qingdao PB Fines were 643, Newman Fines 643, BRBF 696, Newman Lump 833, SSF 505, Carajas Fines 818 and PB Lump 823 yuan/wmt, each up 4 yuan; Mac Fines rose 3 yuan to 649. SGX official current-month FEFV26 was last priced at USD 90.75/dmt, timestamped Oct 23, 17:54:19 (UTC+8).
Drivers	Following the previous broad decline, domestic futures, port spot and seaborne quotations recovered together. The seaborne 61%-65% price differential narrowed slightly from USD 17.65 to 17.60/dmt, while the low-grade port index posted a relatively larger gain. Higher prices may encourage buying, but durability still requires transactions and restocking; a one-day rebound does not establish a trend reversal.
Demand	The latest 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3584 million mt on Oct 21, up 6,400 mt from Oct 14, and a blast furnace operating rate of 87.16%. Improved production supports baseline consumption, but mill stocks, end-user orders and margins still determine purchasing intensity. Persistent buying could improve downside support, while purchases limited to immediate needs could constrain the recovery.
Inventory & supply	Ten-port stocks were 104.6534 million mt on Oct 22, up 632,200 mt (+0.61%) from Oct 15. Fines fell 1.2085 million mt to 82.0793 million mt; concentrates, lump and pellets reached 7.7342, 13.0109 and 1.8290 million mt, increasing by 416,900, 1.3362 million and 87,600 mt, respectively. Different product trends may reflect both arrival composition and collection schedules. Global shipments and Chinese arrivals in the week to Oct 16 were 32.5276 and 24.5464 million mt, down 4.72% and 12.07% WoW.
Cost & margin	Oct 22 freight was USD 33.50/mt for C3, up 3.78% from the previous reading, and 14.20 for C5, up 6.93%. Higher freight may increase costs for some cargoes, while firmer spot selling prices support receipts. Actual trading margins still depend on contracts, settlement timing and exchange rates; import trading, steelmaking and coking profitability should be assessed separately. SMM's assessment published on the morning of Oct 23 put the period's average import margin at 1.03 yuan/mt, down 8.76 yuan from 9.79. This is an import trading assessment, not post-close mill profitability.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	The Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 797.36 yuan/mt on Oct 23, up 0.13% from Oct 22. SMM's current west Liaoning brief quoted concentrate at 640–650 yuan/mt on a wet-basis, tax-exclusive ex-works basis, distinct from the national index in region and pricing terms.
Supply & demand	SMM described subdued trading in west Liaoning. Earlier environmental checks constrained some mining and beneficiation operations, and independent concentrators struggled to source ore, leaving buyers and sellers at an impasse. Supply constraints may support some offers, but actual buying still depends on mill margins and orders.
Outlook	SMM expects west Liaoning concentrate prices to remain range-bound near term. Persistent buying improvement could strengthen sellers' bargaining power amid resource constraints, while limited trading could restrain recovery. Regional moves should be assessed against transactions rather than extrapolated into nationwide gains.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

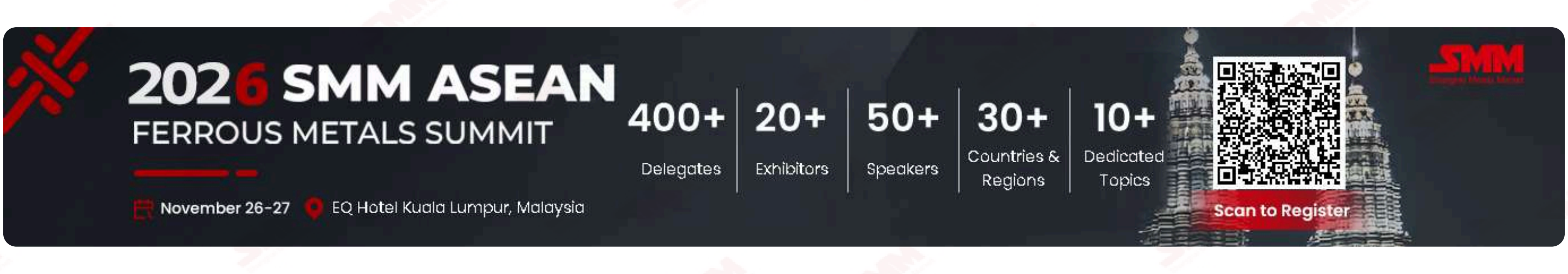
- DCE, all five MMi indices and all 12 seaborne brands recovered.
- Latest daily hot metal output increased 6,400 mt WoW.
- Latest global shipments and Chinese arrivals both declined.
- The domestic ore composite index rose 0.13%.

▼ Bearish factors

- The rebound still needs confirmation from transactions and restocking.
- Port stock absorption depends on collection and unloading schedules.
- Higher C3 and C5 freight may increase some landed costs.
- Mill profitability and end-user orders still constrain buying intensity.

Flash News

- [Brief Comment on Domestic Iron Ore] Iron ore concentrate prices in west Liaoning may consolidate ↗
  2026-10-23
- [Fortescue warns it may cut Pilbara iron ore output if talks with China's buying agency remain unresolved] ↗
  2026-10-23
- [India's Steel Ministry to Hold Open House on Steel Import Issues on Oct 28] ↗
  2026-10-23
- [Canada industry minister gives Cleveland-Cliffs 15 days to reverse Stelco layoffs or face court] ↗
  2026-10-23
- [SMM Steel] India Steel Prices Edge Lower as Buyers Remain Cautious ↗
  2026-10-23
- [SMM Steel] Turkish Rebar: Weak Domestic Intake Drives Prices Down, Export FOB Holds Flat ↗
  2026-10-23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November 26-27 EQ Hotel Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia
400+ Delegates
20+ Exhibitors
50+ Speakers
30+ Countries & Regions
10+ Dedicated Topics
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